SLB (Schlumberger Limited)

A Thematic Analysis of CDP Climate Change Disclosures, 2021–2025

1. Company Introduction

SLB, formerly known as Schlumberger Limited, is the world's largest oilfield services and energy technology company. Founded in 1926 by brothers Conrad and Marcel Schlumberger, the company built its original franchise in well-logging and reservoir evaluation and has since grown into a global energy technology group operating in over 100 countries, with major executive presence in Houston, Paris, London, and The Hague. The company rebranded from "Schlumberger" to "SLB" in 2022 to reflect a broader strategic identity spanning traditional oilfield services, digital solutions, and low-carbon energy technologies.

The company organizes its business into four core divisions: Digital & Integration, Reservoir Performance, Well Construction, and Production Systems. In fiscal year 2025, SLB reported revenue of approximately $35.7 billion and a global workforce of around 109,000 employees, with roughly three-quarters of its revenue generated in international markets. Alongside its core oilfield services business, SLB has increasingly positioned itself around "new energy" ventures — including carbon capture, hydrogen, geothermal, and critical minerals — as part of its response to the energy transition.

As a company whose core business remains deeply tied to fossil-fuel extraction, SLB's annual CDP (Carbon Disclosure Project) Climate Change questionnaire is a key public record of how the company frames its climate governance, emissions performance, risk exposure, and transition strategy to investors and regulators. This report analyzes the thematic content of SLB's CDP submissions across four available reporting years — 2021, 2023, 2024, and 2025 — to identify what the company emphasizes, how that emphasis has shifted over time, and what this suggests about its climate narrative.

2. Methodology

The underlying dataset consists of SLB's CDP Climate Change questionnaire responses, broken into 2,022 individual text paragraphs across the four reporting years (2021, 2023, 2024, 2025; 2022 was not available in the source filings). Each paragraph was coded using python against a set of 15 climate-disclosure themes — spanning governance, strategy, risk, emissions accounting, and stakeholder-facing topics (the full list appears in Section 3).

Because CDP questionnaires are structured around detailed, multi-part questions, a single paragraph frequently touches more than one theme (for example, a paragraph describing a science-based target links both "Targets & Performance" and "Climate Strategy"). On average, each coded paragraph was tagged with 2.6 themes.

Table 1. Coded paragraphs by reporting year

Year	Total paragraphs	Coded paragraphs	% coded
2021	452	294	65.0%
2023	92	92	100.0%
2024	683	494	72.3%
2025	795	587	73.8%

Note: the 2023 filing is a much shorter, condensed submission relative to the other years, which is reflected in its far lower paragraph count but complete thematic coverage — this should be kept in mind when comparing raw counts across years, and is why Section 4 also presents the data as a share of each year's coded content.

3. Overall Theme Frequency

Figure 1 shows the volume of CDP disclosure content assigned to each of the 15 climate-disclosure themes, stacked by reporting year. GHG Emissions is by a wide margin the most consistently discussed theme across every year of SLB's CDP filings, followed by Climate Opportunities, Energy Management, Targets & Performance, and Reporting & Transparency — together these five themes account for the large majority of coded content.

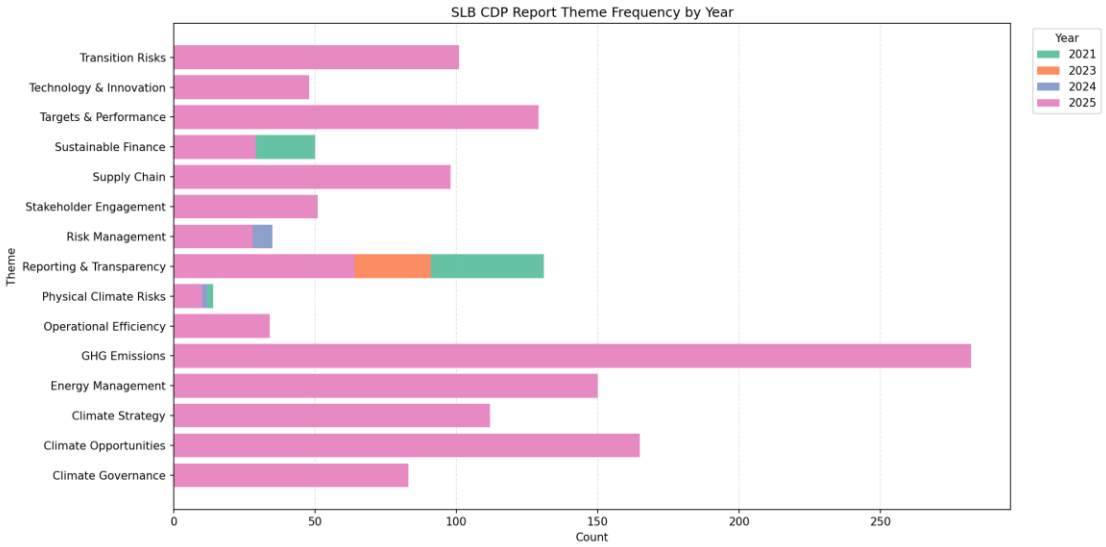


Figure 1. SLB CDP report theme frequency by year (stacked by year of filing).

Table 2. Theme mentions by year (coded paragraph-theme tags)

Theme	2021	2023	2024	2025	Total
GHG Emissions	123	62	240	282	707
Climate Opportunities	65	41	130	165	401
Energy Management	48	62	114	150	374
Targets & Performance	67	37	116	129	349
Reporting & Transparency	131	91	56	64	342
Climate Strategy	68	35	104	112	319
Supply Chain	35	28	83	98	244
Climate Governance	48	25	82	83	238
Transition Risks	26	16	93	101	236
Stakeholder Engagement	24	19	47	51	141
Technology & Innovation	25	23	32	48	128
Sustainable Finance	50	18	24	29	121
Operational Efficiency	17	20	33	34	104
Risk Management	14	12	35	28	89
Physical Climate Risks	14	9	12	10	45

4. Trends Over Time (2021 → 2025)

Because filing length varies considerably by year (the 2023 submission is much shorter than 2024 or 2025), comparing raw counts can be misleading. Normalizing each theme's count against the total coded paragraphs for that year — i.e., what share of that year's disclosure content touched each theme — reveals a clearer picture of where SLB's climate narrative has genuinely shifted emphasis, independent of document length.

4.1 Themes gaining emphasis

- Energy Management rising steadily from 16.3% of coded content in 2021 to 25.6% in 2025 — consistent with SLB's growing emphasis on operational decarbonization and its own energy-transition technology offerings.
- Transition Risks from 8.8% to 17.2%, reflecting increased attention to the financial and strategic risks of the shift away from fossil fuels.
- GHG Emissions already the dominant theme in 2021 (41.8%), it has grown further to 48.0% of coded content in 2025, indicating deepening granularity in emissions accounting and reporting (e.g., Scope 1/2/3 detail).
- Climate Opportunities and Supply Chain show smaller but steady increases, suggesting broader framing of climate action as a business opportunity and growing scrutiny of value-chain emissions.

4.2 Themes losing emphasis

- Reporting & Transparency the single largest shift in the dataset — from 44.6% of content in 2021 (98.9% in the condensed 2023 filing) down to just 10.9% in 2025. This likely reflects a maturing disclosure process: early filings devoted more text to explaining reporting scope, methodology, and assurance processes, while later filings assume this framing is established and focus on substantive content instead.
- Sustainable Finance declining from 17.0% to 4.9%, suggesting reduced emphasis on green bonds, sustainability-linked financing instruments, or ESG-linked capital allocation relative to other themes.
- Climate Strategy and Physical Climate Risks also decline modestly; Climate Governance, Targets & Performance, and Technology & Innovation are essentially flat.

Across all four years, the theme mix appears stable at the top (GHG Emissions has been the leading theme in every single year) but is clearly consolidating: less proportional space is spent on describing the reporting process itself, and more on emissions performance, transition-risk exposure, and energy-management action — a pattern consistent with a disclosure regime shifting from procedural explanation toward performance-oriented substance.

5. Key Observations

- GHG Emissions is the anchor theme of SLB's CDP disclosure in every reporting year, and its relative weight has grown rather than diminished — indicating emissions accounting has become more central, not less, as the filings have matured.
- Reporting & Transparency's steep decline in relative share is the most notable structural shift, pointing to a move away from procedural/methodological framing toward outcome-focused reporting.
- Transition Risks and Energy Management are the two themes with the clearest sustained upward trajectory, aligning with SLB's public positioning around the energy transition and its "new energy" business lines.
- Physical Climate Risks and Risk Management remain the smallest themes throughout (each under 20% of content in any year), suggesting SLB's CDP narrative is weighted more toward mitigation and opportunity framing than toward physical climate risk exposure or enterprise risk management detail.

- The high average of 2.6 themes per coded paragraph reflects the integrated nature of CDP questionnaire responses, where individual answers routinely combine governance, target-setting, and performance reporting in the same passage.

6. Limitations

This analysis is based on a single company's self-reported CDP filings, which are voluntary disclosures subject to the company's own framing choices; thematic prevalence reflects what SLB chose to discuss, not an independent audit of its climate performance. The 2022 filing was not available in the source data, creating a gap in the year-over-year trend. Thematic coding also allows multiple themes per paragraph, so totals in Table 2 will not sum neatly to the total paragraph count — this is expected given the nature of the coding scheme and does not indicate an error in the data.